
INTERNATIONAL AS ENGLISH LITERATURE

Unit 1 Aspects of dramatic tragedy

Wednesday 8 January 2025

07:00 GMT

Time allowed: 2 hours

Materials

For this paper you must have:

- an OxfordAQA 12-page Answer book.

Instructions

- Use black ink or black ball-point pen.
- Write the information required on the front of your answer book.
- Do all rough work in your answer book. Cross through any work you do not want to be marked.
- You must answer **one** question from Section A and **one** question from Section B.
- Remember to include, in both your answers, relevant comments on the authors' dramatic methods in the set texts you are studying.

Information

- The maximum mark for this paper is 50.
- The marks for questions are shown in brackets.
- You will be marked on your ability to:
 - use good English
 - organise information clearly
 - analyse carefully the writers' methods
 - use specialist vocabulary where appropriate.

Section A: Elizabethan and Jacobean tragedy

Answer **one** question from this section.

Either

0	1
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William Shakespeare: *Othello*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Iago and Cassio
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 2 Scene 3**IAGO**

Come, come, good wine is a good familiar creature, if it be well used: exclaim no more against it. And, good lieutenant, I think you think I love you.

CASSIO

I have well approved it, sir. I drunk!

IAGO

You or any man living may be drunk at a time, man. I'll tell you what you shall do: Our general's wife is now the general. I may say so in this respect, for that he hath devoted and given up himself to the contemplation, mark, and denotement of her parts and graces. Confess yourself freely to her; importune her help to put you in your place again. She is of so free, so kind, so apt, so blessed a disposition, she holds it a vice in her goodness not to do more than she is requested. This broken joint between you and her husband entreat her to splinter. And – my fortunes against any lay worth naming – this crack of your love shall grow stronger than it was before.

CASSIO

You advise me well.

IAGO

I protest, in the sincerity of love and honest kindness.

CASSIO

I think it freely; and betimes in the morning I will beseech the virtuous Desdemona to undertake for me. I am desperate of my fortunes if they check me here.

IAGO

You are in the right. Good night, lieutenant: I must to the watch.

CASSIO

Good night, honest Iago.

[Exit]

IAGO

And what's he then that says I play the villain,
When this advice is free I give, and honest,
Probal to thinking, and indeed the course
To win the Moor again? For 'tis most easy
The inclining Desdemona to subdue
In any honest suit. She's framed as fruitful
As the free elements; and then for her
To win the Moor — were't to renounce his baptism,
All seals and symbols of redeemed sin —
His soul is so enfettered to her love
That she may make, unmake, do what she list,
Even as her appetite shall play the god
With his weak function. How am I then a villain
To counsel Cassio to this parallel course
Directly to his good? Divinity of hell!
When devils will the blackest sins put on,
They do suggest at first with heavenly shows,
As I do now. For, whiles this honest fool
Plies Desdemona to repair his fortune,
And she for him pleads strongly to the Moor,
I'll pour this pestilence into his ear:
That she repeals him for her body's lust;
And by how much she strives to do him good
She shall undo her credit with the Moor.
So will I turn her virtue into pitch,
And out of her own goodness make the net
That shall enmesh them all.

Turn over for the next question

or

0	2
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William Shakespeare: *King Lear*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Lear and the other characters
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 5 Scene 3

[Re-enter King Lear, with Cordelia dead in his arms; Edgar, Captain, and others following]

KING LEAR

Howl, howl, howl, howl! O, you are men of stones.
 Had I your tongues and eyes, I would use them so
 That heaven's vault should crack. She's gone for ever.
 I know when one is dead and when one lives.
 She's dead as earth.
[He lays her down]
 Lend me a looking-glass;
 If that her breath will mist or stain the stone,
 Why, then she lives.

KENT

Is this the promised end?

EDGAR

Or image of that horror?

ALBANY

Fall, and cease!

KING LEAR

This feather stirs. She lives. If it be so,
 It is a chance which does redeem all sorrows
 That ever I have felt.

KENT

[Kneeling] Ah, my good master!

KING LEAR

Prithee, away.

EDGAR

'Tis noble Kent, your friend.

KING LEAR

A plague upon you, murderous traitors all.
I might have saved her; now she's gone for ever. –
Cordelia, Cordelia: stay a little. Ha?
What is't thou say'st? – Her voice was ever soft,
Gentle, and low, an excellent thing in women. –
I killed the slave that was a-hanging thee.

CAPTAIN

'Tis true, my lords, he did.

KING LEAR

Did I not, fellow?
I have seen the day with my good biting falchion
I would have made them skip. I am old now,
And these same crosses spoil me. [*To Kent*] Who are you?
Mine eyes are not o' the best, I'll tell you straight.

KENT

If fortune bragged of two she loved or hated,
One of them we behold.

KING LEAR

Are you not Kent?

KENT

The same, your servant Kent. Where is your servant Caius?

KING LEAR

He's a good fellow, I can tell you that.
He'll strike, and quickly too. He's dead and rotten.

KENT

No, my good lord; I am the very man –

KING LEAR

I'll see that straight.

KENT

That from your first of difference and decay
Have followed your sad steps.

KING LEAR

You're are welcome hither.

This extract continues on the next page

KENT

Nor no man else. All's cheerless, dark, and deadly.
Your eldest daughters have fordone themselves,
And desperately are dead.

KING LEAR

So think I, too.

ALBANY

He knows not what he sees; and vain it is
That we present us to him.

EDGAR

Very bootless.

[Enter another Captain]

CAPTAIN

Edmund is dead, my lord.

ALBANY

That's but a trifle here. –
You lords and noble friends, know our intent.
What comfort to this great decay may come
Shall be applied; for us, we will resign
During the life of this old majesty,
To him our absolute power; *[To Edgar and Kent]* you to your rights,
With boot and such addition as your honours
Have more than merited. All friends shall taste
The wages of their virtue, and all foes
The cup of their deservings. – O, see, see!

Turn over for the next question

or

0	3
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William Shakespeare: *Hamlet*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Polonius and Ophelia
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 2 Scene 1

POLONIUS

Farewell! [*Exit Reynoldo*]

[*Enter Ophelia*]

How now, Ophelia! What's the matter?

OPHELIA

Alas, my lord, I have been so affrighted.

POLONIUS

With what, i' the name of God?

OPHELIA

My lord, as I was sewing in my chamber,
 Lord Hamlet, with his doublet all unbraced,
 No hat upon his head, his stockings fouled,
 Ungartered, and down-gyved to his ankle,
 Pale as his shirt, his knees knocking each other,
 And with a look so piteous in purport
 As if he had been loosed out of hell
 To speak of horrors, he comes before me.

POLONIUS

Mad for thy love?

OPHELIA

My lord, I do not know,
 But truly I do fear it.

POLONIUS

What said he?

OPHELIA

He took me by the wrist and held me hard.
 Then goes he to the length of all his arm,
 And, with his other hand thus o'er his brow,

He falls to such perusal of my face
As he would draw it. Long stayed he so.
At last, a little shaking of mine arm,
And thrice his head thus waving up and down,
He raised a sigh so piteous and profound
As it did seem to shatter all his bulk
And end his being. That done, he lets me go,
And, with his head over his shoulder turned,
He seemed to find his way without his eyes,
For out o' doors he went without their help,
And to the last bended their light on me.

POLONIUS

Come, go with me. I will go seek the King.
This is the very ecstasy of love,
Whose violent property fordoes itself,
And leads the will to desperate undertakings
As oft as any passion under heaven
That does afflict our natures. I am sorry –
What, have you given him any hard words of late?

OPHELIA

No, my good lord, but as you did command
I did repel his letters, and denied
His access to me.

POLONIUS

That hath made him mad.
I am sorry that with better speed and judgement
I had not quoted him. I feared he did but trifle
And meant to wreck thee. But beshrew my jealousy!
By heaven, it is as proper to our age
To cast beyond ourselves in our opinions
As it is common for the younger sort
To lack discretion. Come, go we to the King.
This must be known, which, being kept close, might move
More grief to hide than hate to utter love.
[Exeunt]

Turn over for the next question

or

0	4
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Christopher Marlowe: *Doctor Faustus*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Faustus and the other characters
- Marlowe's use of dramatic language
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 4 Scene 2

BENVOLIO

The devil's dead. The Furies now may laugh.

FREDERICK

Was this that stern aspect, that awful frown,
Made the grim monarch of infernal spirits
Tremble and quake at his commanding charms?

MARTINO

Was this that damned head, whose heart conspired
Benvolio's shame before the emperor?

BENVOLIO

Ay, that's the head and here the body lies,
Justly rewarded for his villainies.

FREDERICK

Come, let's devise how we may add more shame
To the black scandal of his hated name.

BENVOLIO

First, on his head, in quittance of my wrongs,
I'll nail huge forked horns and let them hang
Within the window where he yoked me first,
That all the world may see my just revenge.

MARTINO

What use shall we put his beard to?

BENVOLIO

We'll sell it to a chimney-sweeper. It will wear out ten birchen brooms, I warrant you.

FREDERICK

What shall his eyes do?

BENVOLIO

We'll put out his eyes, and they shall serve for buttons to his lips to keep his tongue from catching cold.

MARTINO

An excellent policy. And now, sirs, having divided him, what shall the body do?

[Faustus rises]

BENVOLIO

Zounds, the devil's alive again!

FREDERICK

Give him his head, for God's sake!

FAUSTUS

Nay, keep it. Faustus will have heads and hands,
 Aye, all your hearts, to recompense this deed.
 Knew you not, traitors, I was limited
 For four-and-twenty years to breathe on earth?
 And had you cut my body with your swords,
 Or hewed this flesh and bones as small as sand,
 Yet in a minute had my spirit returned,
 And I had breathed a man made free from harm.
 But wherefore do I dally my revenge?
 Ashtaroath, Belimoth, Mephistopheles!
[Enter Mephistopheles and other Devils]
 Go horse these traitors on your fiery backs,
 And mount aloft with them as high as heaven;
 Thence pitch them headlong to the lowest hell.
 Yet stay. The world shall see their misery,
 And hell shall after plague their treachery.
 Go, Belimoth and take this caitiff hence,
 And hurl him in some lake of mud and dirt.

[To Ashtaroath]

Take thou this other; drag him through the woods
 Amongst the pricking thorns and sharpest briars,
 Whilst with my gentle Mephistopheles
 This traitor flies unto some steep rock,
 That rolling down, may break the villain's bones,
 As he intended to dismember me.
 Fly hence. Dispatch my charge immediately.

FREDERICK

Pity us, gentle Faustus. Save our lives!

FAUSTUS

Away!

FREDERICK

He must needs go that the devil drives.

This extract continues on the next page

[Exeunt Spirits with the Knights. Enter the ambushed Soldiers]

FIRST SOLDIER

Come, sirs. Prepare yourselves in readiness;
Make haste to help these noble gentlemen.
I heard them parley with the conjuror.

SECOND SOLDIER

See where he comes. Dispatch, and kill the slave.

FAUSTUS

What's here? An ambush to betray my life?
Then, Faustus, try thy skill. Base peasants, stand!
For lo, these trees remove at my command
And stand as bulwarks 'twixt yourselves and me
To shield me from your hated treachery.
Yet to encounter this your weak attempt,
Behold an army comes incontinent.

*[Faustus strikes the door, and enter a devil playing on a drum,
after him another bearing an ensign, and divers with
weapons, Mephistopheles with fireworks. They set upon
the Soldiers and drive them out.]*

Turn over for the next question

or

0	5
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John Webster: *The Duchess of Malfi*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Delio and Antonio
- Webster's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 5 Scene 3

[Enter Antonio and Delio. There is an echo from the Duchess's grave]

DELIO

Yon's the Cardinal's window. This fortification
Grew from the ruins of an ancient abbey,
And to yond side o' th' river lies a wall,
Piece of a cloister, which in my opinion
Gives the best echo that you ever heard:
So hollow, and so dismal, and withal
So plain in the distinction of our words,
That many have supposed it is a spirit
That answers.

ANTONIO

I do love these ancient ruins:
We never tread upon them but we set
Our foot upon some reverend history.
And, questionless, here in this open court,
Which now lies naked to the injuries
Of stormy weather, some men lie interred
Loved the church so well, and gave so largely to't,
They thought it should have canopied their bones
Till doomsday. But all things have their end:
Churches and cities, which have diseases like to men,
Must have like death that we have.

ECHO

Like death that we have.

DELIO

Now the echo hath caught you.

ANTONIO

It groaned, methought, and gave
A very deadly accent.

ECHO

Deadly accent.

DELIO

I told you 'twas a pretty one. You may make it
A huntsman, or a falconer, a musician,
Or a thing of sorrow.

ECHO

A thing of sorrow.

ANTONIO

Ay, sure, that suits it best.

ECHO

That suits it best.

ANTONIO

'Tis very like my wife's voice.

ECHO

Ay, wife's voice.

DELIO

Come, let us walk further from't.
I would not have you go to th' Cardinal's tonight:
Do not.

ECHO

Do not.

DELIO

Wisdom doth not more moderate wasting sorrow
Than time. Take time for't; be mindful of thy safety.

ECHO

Be mindful of thy safety.

ANTONIO

Necessity compels me.
Make scrutiny throughout the passes
Of your own life, you'll find it impossible
To fly your fate.

ECHO

O, fly your fate.

DELIO

Hark, the dead stones seem to have pity on you
And give you good counsel.

This extract continues on the next page

ANTONIO

Echo, I will not talk with thee,
For thou art a dead thing.

ECHO

Thou art a dead thing.

ANTONIO

My Duchess is asleep now,
And her little ones, I hope, sweetly. O heaven,
Shall I never see her more?

ECHO

Never see her more.

ANTONIO

I marked not one repetition of the echo
But that; and on the sudden, a clear light
Presented me a face folded in sorrow.

DELIO

Your fancy, merely.

ANTONIO

Come, I'll be out of this ague;
For to live thus is not indeed to live:
It is a mockery, and abuse of life.
I will not henceforth save myself by halves;
Lose all, or nothing.

DELIO

Your own virtue save you.
I'll fetch your eldest son, and second you;
It may be that the sight of his own blood,
Spread in so sweet a figure, may beget
The more compassion.

ANTONIO

However, fare you well.
Though in our miseries Fortune have a part,
Yet in our noble sufferings she hath none:
Contempt of pain, that we may call our own.

[*Exeunt*]

There are no questions printed on this page

Turn over for Section B

Section B: Later dramatic tragedies

Answer **one** question from this section.

Either

0	6
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Arthur Miller: *Death of a Salesman*

‘Willy Loman is caught in a trap which is essentially of his own making.’

To what extent do you agree with this view of the way that Willy is presented in the tragedy of *Death of a Salesman*?

[25 marks]

or

0	7
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Tennessee Williams: *A Streetcar Named Desire*

‘In *A Streetcar named Desire*, sexual desire is always a tragically disruptive force.’

How far do you agree with this view of the way that sexual desire is presented in the play?

[25 marks]

or

0	8
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Henrik Ibsen: *Hedda Gabler*

‘Hedda brings about her own tragic downfall. She is to blame for what happens to her.’

To what extent do you agree with this view of the way that Hedda is presented in the tragedy of *Hedda Gabler*?

[25 marks]

or

0	9
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Samuel Beckett: *Waiting for Godot*

What is the dramatic and tragic significance of Godot in *Waiting for Godot*?

[25 marks]

or

1	0
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Brian Friel: *Translations*

What is the dramatic and tragic significance of the title of the play *Translations*?

[25 marks]

END OF QUESTIONS

There are no questions printed on this page

There are no questions printed on this page

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